

The lads in their hundreds

A. E. Housman

Arthur Somervell

Allegretto ma con molto espressione *mf*

Voice

Piano

p

The

2

lads in their hun - dreds to Lud - low come in for the fair, There's

mf

3

men from the barn and the forge and the mill and the fold, The

4

lads for the girls, and the lads for the li - quor are there, And

5 *espress.*

there with the rest are the lads that will nev - er be old.

6 *mf*

There's

7

chaps from the town and the field and the till and the cart, And

8

man - y to count are the stal - wart, and man - y the brave, And

9

man - y the hand - some of face and the hand - some of heart; And

10 *espress.*

few that will car - ry their looks or their truth to the grave.

mf

11 *meno mosso*

I

12

wish one could know them, I wish there were tokens to tell The

13

for - tun - ate fel - lows that now you can nev - er dis - cern; And

14

then one could talk with them friend - ly and wish them fare -

15

- well, And watch them de - part on the way that they will not re -

17 **Tempo I.**

- turn.

p

18 *pp*

But

19

now you may stare as you like but there's noth - ing to scan; And

pp

20

brush - ing your el - bow un - guessed at and not be told They

21 *cresc.* *f rall.*

car - ry back bright to the coin - er the min - tage of man, The

22 *ff*

lads that will die in their glo - ry, the lads that will

23 *rall.* *ff*

die in their glo - ry and nev - er be old

24 *rit.*